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House speaker's earmark raises eyebrows

Mariano uses surplus from new tax on high earners for \$25m parking garage

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

Moments before passing a bill last month about how to spend surplus cash generated by the state's "millionaires tax," the Massachusetts House added a final, sweeping amendment. Its biggest beneficiary: House Speaker Ron Mariano's

hometown of Quincy, which would receive \$25 million from the stockpile for a new 500-spot garage.

The measure, inserted at the behest of the chamber's most powerful Democrat, was by far the biggest local earmark House leaders added to the \$1.3 billion spending bill, and it made the South Shore city a win-

ner in the jostling for the sought-after revenue.

Its quiet inclusion without debate frustrated some supporters of the state's two-year-old surtax on high-earners, who argued that hand-picking money for a parking structure stretches the spirit of a law intended to support education and to maintain Massachusetts' "roads, bridges, and public transportation."

"It's certainly not what I was out

there knocking on doors for," said Jeanne Kempthorne, a retired attorney who chaired the Berkshires Fair Share Committee, a regional group that campaigned for the 2022 ballot question that established the 4 percent surtax on annual income over \$1 million. Tapping the revenue for a parking garage that's not directly

GARAGE, Page A10

'No amount of baby fever can overcome economic anxiety right now.'

TIERNEY ELISON, a midwife and mother of two



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Colleen Nguyen played with her son, Zach, 5, at their Newton home. She would like to have a second child but costs are too high.

Bearing the cost of child-bearing

As the White House pushes women to have more babies, those who want them say they can't afford it

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

Colleen Nguyen always thought she would have two children. Then she had her first.

She loves her son, Zach, a giggly 5-year-old with a penchant for sea creatures and Hot Wheels, and would love to give him a sibling. But the price tag of parenthood has far exceeded her expectations. These days, Zach's nursery school and day care eat up anywhere from about \$2,000 to \$2,200 every month — not far from what she and her husband pay for the rent on their two-bedroom in Newton.

Between those bills and the copays on Zach's health care — he has autism and a vision disorder — the thought of adding another child to the picture feels "practically impossible," she said — especially if they were to ever try to afford to buy a

house that could accommodate a growing family.

"It took me handing over the day care bills to my parents for them to understand," Nguyen said. "They would just be like, 'Oh, well, you can just have another one. It all works out. You can't really just plan for them.' And I'm like, 'No. Look at these numbers.'"

The Trump administration has made it clear it wants women to have more children, with aides reportedly evaluating policy recommendations aimed at incentivizing higher fertility rates, from a \$5,000 "baby bonus" when a woman gives birth to a "National Medal of Motherhood" for mothers with six or more kids. There are plenty of women in Massachusetts who would love to welcome the babies the White House covets — if only they could afford it.

The Globe spoke with more than 20 women who

Fertility rates in Massachusetts and the US

The rate represents the number of births per 1,000 women ages 15-44.

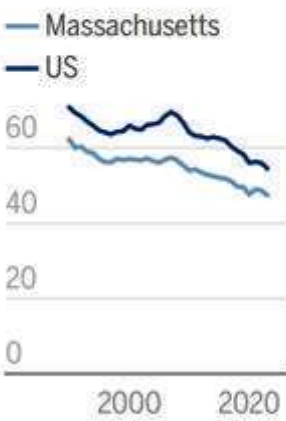


Chart: DANA GERBER/GLOBE STAFF • Source: March of Dimes

CHILDREN, Page A6

Israel set to launch 'forceful' Gaza plan

Cabinet backs seizing territory, relocating Palestinians to south

By Michael D. Shear, Aaron Boxerman, and Adam Rasgon
NEW YORK TIMES

JERUSALEM — Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel declared Monday that his country is "on the eve of a forceful entry to Gaza" after his security Cabinet approved a plan for tens of thousands of additional soldiers to seize and hold territory in the embattled enclave and relocate Palestinians to the south.

In a video posted to social media as military reservists across Israel began receiving notices of their call-up, Netanyahu said the country's top military officials had recommended what he called an "intensive" escalation of the 18-month war.

"It's time to launch the concluding moves," Netanyahu said the military officials told him, adding that the new campaign would help bring home the hostages still being held in Gaza. The prime minister said he believes "we are not done. We are before the finish line."

The escalation followed more than two months in which Israel continued to blockade and bombard the Gaza Strip as cease-fire talks to free the remaining hostages ground to a near standstill. Israel has barred any humanitarian aid to Gaza in an effort to press Hamas to surrender, leading aid groups to denounce mounting deprivation among Palestinians there.

GAZA, Page A4

Detained Tufts student flags state of facility

Describes overcrowding, inadequate medical care

By Samantha J. Gross and Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

Rümeysa Öztürk, a Tufts University doctoral candidate student, has endured crowded and contaminated dorms, 45-minute asthma attacks, and uncontrollable coughing while being held in federal immigration detention in rural Louisiana, she said in new court filings.

Öztürk, who has chronic asthma, renewed her call for bail or transfer to Vermont, where a judge has ordered she be returned. While her struggles with asthma have been documented, the latest filings detail a more revealing glimpse into her conditions in Louisiana.

"It has become progressively harder to recover from these asthma attacks while in detention," said Öztürk, who was picked up by federal agents in March in Somerville. "I am very concerned about the severity of these attacks and my ability to manage them."

Öztürk said she has also been enduring "almost

TUFTS STUDENT, Page A6



Stuck in pour house

Tuesday: Downpours. High 57-62, low 52-57.

Wednesday: Cloudy, showers. High 65-70, low 55-60.

Sunrise: 5:33. Sunset: 7:49

Weather and comics, **D5-6**.

Obituaries, **C9**.

US targets Harvard grants

Trump administration says the university will no longer be eligible for new research grants until it complies with its demands. **B1.**

City Councilor Tania Fernandes Anderson pleaded guilty to wire fraud and theft charges for taking a \$7,000 kickback. **B1.**

Boston joined a lawsuit over \$3.6 billion in federal grants to address homelessness and improve transit. **B1.**

Symiotic is cutting 400 jobs as the warehouse automation company combines a Walmart unit it acquired with its own operations. **D1.**

How a trip to a jungle helped Mazzulla be coach Celtics needed

By Adam Himmelsbach
GLOBE STAFF

When the Celtics lost Game 7 of the 2023 Eastern Conference finals to the Heat, first-year coach Joe Mazzulla was at a low point. But he believed that to truly chase greatness, he needed to be crushed.

He was texting about it with Josh Waitzkin, a former child chess prodigy whose story was chronicled in the 1993 Oscar-nominated film "Searching for Bobby Fischer."

"He was pissed," Waitzkin said. "He also knew it was time to take himself on."

The two had grown close that season after Waitzkin conducted a performance psychology seminar for the Celtics' coaching staff.

Now, even though they had never met in person, Waitzkin urged Mazzulla to visit his home tucked away in a Costa Rican jungle, where they would tear Mazzulla down to build him

MAZZULLA, Page A7



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

A STUNNING COLLAPSE — Boston Celtics guards Jaylen Brown (right) and Jrue Holiday walked off the court after falling, 108-105, to the New York Knicks in overtime in Game One of the NBA Eastern Conference semifinal at the TD Garden. **C1.**